Living Room

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Teen And Up Audiences

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F/F

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Character:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra)

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Jock Adora (She-Ra), Neighbors, Exercise/Running, Based on a Tegan and Sara Song, Getting Together, Cotton Candy Fluff

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by MSinshine

Summary

Catra begins to notice her neighbor, that blonde chick, is suddenly home more often than before. And lifting weights a ton. And going out for runs. It's pure coincidence that Catra begins a new exercise routine that just so happens to correspond with the other woman's outdoor runs. Only so many hours in a day, after all…

Notes

Hello, friends! So, I'll begin by saying that I posted this back in April or so as chapter 2 of the Salute Your Shorts! series. At the time, it did not occur to me to make each work just one part of the overall series. Around the time of Cinderdora, I started to post like that and found I like the format so much better. I debated strongly about whether I should delete the chapters I had before and repost... and finally decided to.

I am sad to lose the comments, but if you were kind enough to be one of the people to leave me one during the first post, please know that I've taken a screenshot of each one and saved them. They mean so much to me.

Just as before, this story is a requested one-shot with a T rating and the tags "Jock Adora" and "Based off a Tegan & Sara song" and it only happened because of the amazing idea from ButterfliesInMyBrain who said to base it off Living Room by Tegan & Sara where Catra is kind of stalking Adora... but in a cute way. And of course it still contains artwork by Tara, @TaraCandyCorn on Twitter. Enjoy!

Technically it wasn't watching if her living room just happened to look into theirs right? It at least wasn't stalker levels of creepy if anytime she wanted to look out into the state of the world Catra was primarily faced with the view of someone else's apartment. Really, it was just poor building design. And when that person had the habit of making very loud, distracting noises as she lifted things that weighed more than a couple of toddlers put together, well, Catra's ears were sensitive. Of course she would look up from time to time.

Furrowing her brow at the sounds coming from across the short gap between their apartment buildings and realizing it was the blonde chick at her bench *again*, Catra sighed. She didn't begrudge anyone that wanted to embrace that healthy lifestyle, even if she herself preferred naps over reps, but was the grunting truly an integral part of the activity? It was distracting on so many levels. How in the world did Catra just ignore all that noise before now? Come to think of it, it really only started happening incessantly over the last week or so. Her ear flicked as she heard the woman swapping out the weighted plates once more before turning her attention back to her book, pushing any thought of her neighbor out of her head.

The hard fought indifference did not last over the days that followed. What was this girl's deal? Truly, was the pursuit to bulging biceps and hefty hamstrings really worth *that* much time with free weights? That didn't even count the daily runs sometimes in the morning, sometimes during the evening. Maybe it was all based on her work schedule; who knew. Catra would just see the woman stretching in her living room or lacing up her sneakers and knew within 30 seconds she'd see the blonde hit the pavement outside their buildings. Always in the same direction though. Probably ran in the park nearby; that's at least what Catra would do if she were inclined to do such things.

The first time Catra found herself tossing on shorts and a tank top and rushing out her front door, the woman was already so far ahead that the angry cat had no chance of catching up. Jeez, people did this for fun? Barely ten minutes in and she was panting. Huh, if her

younger self could see this, that jerk would be laughing herself to an early grave. Then again, the longer Catra forced her legs to trudge on the pavement, the more she felt she was headed to one anyway.

The third time she was at least already schlepping along the sidewalk by the time her neighbor passed her. The woman did not even bother to call out a "On your left!" just jogged by, neatly diving past Catra with her face entirely neutral and obviously focused. The magicat frowned at the passing figure, but honestly, they were barely past their apartment complex and she was already a sweating mess, so maybe it was for the best.

The evening runs were easier on her or maybe the results of two weeks of forgoing her sedentary life were beginning to show. Her Poof, as Catra had taken to calling her neighbor, had begun to at least nod to her before she Catra passed by. She wondered if the blonde even registered that they were neighbors, let alone ones that shared a view. The other woman really only seemed to exercise and sleep, though Catra suspected she wasnt independently wealthy and had to at least work part time. She added it to the list of ever-growing questions she swore she would ask. Once she got the opportunity.

"... You know," The blonde breathed out after pausing her music and slowing her pace down. Catra always tried to keep a respectable distance. Sure they had the same running route, down to the park and around the trail there, but. She didnt need to make it *weird*. If you're going to keep coming out here, you might want to consider wearing shoes."

Catra pretended to pause her non-existent running playlist as well. Okay, maybe she could have just kept one going on *low*, but what if this chick had a soft voice? She wasnt going to miss hearing her for some overly peppy, let's get hype and *sweat it out*! music. The beat

of her padded feet was enough to keep her entertained, not to mention the chance to follow the bouncing hair poof in front of her. Coincidentally, of course. She flashed the blonde a quick smile and took the comment as an invitation to fall in line beside her. After nearly a month of doing this, she found it wasn't quite as difficult to talk and jog as she might have thought at the start. "Nah, not my style. Can't stand feeling cramped like that." The other woman gave a non-committal grunt and faced forward again, obviously preparing to regain her original pace. Maybe even leave Catra behind again. Not a chance, blondie. Catra rolled out her shoulders and gave a well-practiced yawn. "Yeah, besides. Definitely don't need any stupid shoes to outrun you."…

The jogger blinked once, then twice, before coming to complete halt. "Excuse me?"

Catra swallowed, wondering if perhaps she'd gabbled too much, but decided to keep pressing her luck. She just had a feeling this girl was *competitive*. She circled around, coming to stand a few feet from the bemused blonde. "You heard me."

"Awfully bold talk for a newbie."

"How do you know I'm new to running?"

"Your form, your breathing, the fact you don't stretch up before, or cool down after."…

"Wow! Have you been watching me or something?" Catra snickered inwardly at her own cheekiness. Again, it wasn't *watching* if the only window in her own dang living room faced that way.

To Catra's great relief the woman actually smiled. It was small and a little out of practice, but it was absolutely worth the month long delay when it arrived. "I'll give you something to watch; me as I pass by. Just like every day."

"Say , what's your name?" The magicat asked, emboldened by the fact her neighbor was returning the volley. *Yes* !

"Uh, Adora." Adora shook her head clear of the whiplash. "And yours?"

"W ell, Adora," Catra rocked back on her heels before taking of f in a sprint. "First one to the bridge wins!" The bridge in the park couldn't be more than a mile away , nothing she couldn't dash to. And then? Well, she'd figure it out in the time it took Adora to meet her there.

"What? Hey , wait!" The stunned blonde picked up her feet after a moment, charging of f after the hurtling magicat.

Even despite the delay in her start, Adora only arrived seconds after Catra did, actually panting slightly, a fact Catra was supremely proud of. Sure Catra herself was absolutely heaving and the stitch in her side hurt like hell, but not bad for a newbie.

"That was pretty low ." The blonde leaned back against the stonework of the bridge, breathing deeply to even out.

"Adora, you'll find out soon enough that nothing' s too low for me" Catra gave a wink, before blushing, uncertain how her words would be received.

The jogger lifted one eyebrow . "Huh. Alright, so can I know your name *now* ?

"Sure! Y ou should know what to engrave your trophy with." The magicat joined the blonde in her lean, wincing a little as her calves seized. Not the time, muscles. She was getting somewhere. "Name' s Catra."

"Catra." Adora nodded, looking of f in the distance a ways over the pond. Catra decided very quickly that she liked how it rolled of f the blonde's tongue. "How about a rematch tomorrow? Except this time, we go for distance."

The sink Adora gave as she extended her challenge would end up being well worth all the blisters, muscle cramps, and sore defeat that came for Catra the following day.

"You really should stretch after a run, especially a long one." The blonde coached, bending over in a lunge to stretch out the back of her legs. Catra forcibly looked the other direction, glad that the blonde was not facing her so had no way of knowing how badly Catra was trying to not look.

Tail twitching as she studied the fascinating leaves of the hedges that lined the front of Adora's building (Were they greener than hers? Yes, definitely greener, interesting!) Catra finally got a hold of herself. She sank from the bottom step, readjusting her pose so that an elbow was propped on one knee, the other leg slung out below her. Okay, yes, they were throbbing and honestly a stretch would probably feel *amazing*, but giving Adora a hard time was worth the vast discomfort. "You really do love offering unprompted advice, don't you?" She made sure to keep her tone light and teasing.

The blonde rose to her full height, which was only maybe three inches taller than Catra's (but the magicat was all about those extra 7.62 centimeters), and crossed her right leg behind her left, raising her right arm over her head in an arc shape.

Catra's eye twitched for just a moment as she followed the curve of Adora's waist before swallowing thickly, back to studying the hedges intently. Their landscaping crew was really so precise; not a branch longer than the rest or a leaf out of place. Remarkable.

Adora finished her full body stretch and turned around to give the perched magicat a hollow half-smile. "You're not the only one to point that out recently." Her eyes grew cloudy for a moment before she shrugged, seeming to toss something from her mind with a heavy sigh. Catra didn't quite know how to respond, but she was spared when the blonde gave a curt nod. "All right, if I can't convince you that letting your muscles cool down will make for a better day tomorrow, at least let me bring you out a post-run smoothie. All I

have is banana flavored, but Iswear that it' s actually not that bad. And you've gotta be hungry after five ine."

Catra's stomach twinged, though it was hard to say if it was from hunger pangs, excitement, or the prospect of ingesting cold, fake banana flavoring. But a chance to keep spending a little more time with her neighbor.She had to play it cool though. "Y ou sure? It' s getting late. Idont wanna interrupt any dinner plans you might have for tonight."

"No plans."The two words were frosted over , but not nearly as frozen as the t" s just m"that followed them

Catra nodded, neatly moving past what was obviously a sore topic. "Right. W ell, in that case, blend 'em up! I mean, we could be eating pizza, but who would want that over banana, milk, and ice?"

"And whey protein powder , cant forget that."Adora mumbled out. She was distracted, but trying. Catra could work with trying.

"Mtop choice in a meal;forget Chinese takeout."

The fact that her dumbjoke merited a tiny sputtering of laughter was worth sucking down every drop of the weirdly sweet and kinda grainy half-melted glop in a cup. It really wasnt actually that bad, especially when by the bottom of the glass, Adora' s foot was resting against her own.

"Sorry Icouldnt join you tonight."Catra frowned from her porch, shifting her work bag to her shoulder and placing the random groceries she'd picked up on her way homedown to maybe invite a chance for longer conversation. Sucked the sun was already setting; knowing Adora, she would have been able to convince the blonde to

lace up for a quick jog otherwise. A two-week streak of runs together broken by the demands of capitalism. Damn. Later shift than usual today."

Adora had been in the midst of her normal post-run stretches out in the yard when Catra returned home. The blonde smirked briefly at the sight of her car, even breaking her pose to wave back when the catgirl had. She dropped her leg back down to the earth, quad stretches paused for the moment, and called over towards her neighbor. "No worries. Wasn't I could go a lot further today since no one was there to slow me down."

The teasing had become their normal, so Catra was unphased by the small clip. "Explains why you're so sweaty . Go shower; I'm gonna be eating dinner and you're killing my appetite."

The rude gesture Adora sent in reply wasn't lost in the fading sunlight.

Catra had just taken a large bite of her Caesar salad when she saw movement out of the corner of her eye. Oh, it was just Adora finally coming back in from the yard and flicking on her living room light. Nothing particularly noteworthy. Catra turned back to her dinner, idly scrolling on her phone as she sat on her couch after a long day. Another blip registering on the periphery of her vision told her that Adora was done in her living room and had turned off the light. Just barely in line with what Catra's window in her living room would show of her friend's neighboring apartment, Catra caught sight of one more light coming on, the dimmed and blurry light through the thick privacy glass windows of the bathroom. Shower time. Right. Totally normal to get cleaned up after a long run.

Normal, normal, normal.

Catra was going to lose sleep, lose her mind, or both if she didn't find something to occupy herself from thoughts of normal *right now* .

"So," Catra asked over her glass of wine. A definite improvement over whey powder. It only took another two weeks of daily runs to convince Adora that a little break from her post-workout routine wouldn't really tank her gains all that much. "I think we're at the point of knowing one another where I can ask this. What's the deal with all the workouts, really? You were going pretty hard there right at first." The weight lifting had slowed down considerably, though not much would postpone their evening run together.

The easy smile that had been on Adora's face ever since the veggie lo mein and wontons had arrived and the moscato had been unscrewed (corks were for classy folk) quickly faded at the question. It was replaced with furrowed brows and a curve of her lips downward. Catra saw for a second a flash of hurt in those baby blues and almost regretted asking, but she had her suspicions. Maybe after spending part of every day for the past two months together, Adora might be ready to talk about her hurt a little?

The blonde thumbed at her own glass, staring into the bright pink liquid within. It was no fine vintage, but still Adora swirled it around as she considered. "You know what? I don't think it matters anymore." Before Catra could give a teasing protest at that total avoidant non-answer, the blonde whispered shyly, another genuine smile tugging at the corner of her lips. "I don't think *she* matters anymore." Adora quickly rose from the couch, cheeks the same color as the contents of her wine glass, gathering up the dishes from their shared meal and hurrying off to the kitchen.

Catra hoped she never found out who broke Adora's heart, because if she did...

She wouldn't know whether to deck them or thank them

Hair Don't Care (6:37 AM) No run today?

Catra barely had the time to glance at her watch to scan the message (wow, how the months could change a person, she wore a *fitness tracker* now). She frowned up at the sky, willing the clouds that were rolling in to roll back out before slowing down just long enough to type out a quick response.

Shoeless & Stubborn (6:37 AM) Already out. Almost to the park, see you in fifteen?

She knew Adora could make it in less than ten, but it was just too fun to tease her. Catra could clearly picture the scoff as the blonde saw her message, jaw set as Adora loped along their route, determined to make even better time than normal.

Shoeless & Stubborn (6:42 AM) Met at bridge?

Her hands shook as she sent the message. There was no *reason* to be this nervous- maybe, hopefully. Catra had a plan, Adora was on her way. The gray cast overhead was a bit of a bummer, but so long as it didn't start to rain. She flattened down the collar of her shirt one last time and adopted that same casual, but entirely *not*

casual, lean she had all those months ago after their first race to this spot to wait for Adora.

"Uh, hey." The questioning lilt to Adora's greeting had no right to be that cute. The blonde cocked her head, taking in Catra's attire. "I thought you were out running already?"

Catra swallowed, nodding slowly. "Yeah, heh, well. You know." Adora smirked at her fluster, which just flummoxed the angelcat all the more. C'mon, Adora, be nice. "N-not tonight. I was thinking that maybe you and I could go have some dinner? Maybe talk?"

The blonde looked at the view of the water the bridge afforded them, seemingly focused on it and it alone. Before Catra could pass out from holding her breath, Adora finally spoke. "Seems a little unfair that I'm dressed in this," The woman plucked at the front of her moisture-wicking cotton top, "While you look." Blue eyes gave an appreciative full body appraisal, her voice dropping low as a result of her findings. "Like *that*."

"Ah, yes. Well,-..." Catra maybe hadn't thought this part through. But it was still kind of cute, right? She cleared her throat, thinking quickly. It should not be this challenging to come up with a resolution, but Adora was *looking* at her and *smiling* at her and Catra was left trying to remember how to *breathe*. She focused on just how badly she wanted a chance to talk with this woman. Confess a couple things… Or maybe just one big thing. "We could head home and you could change? Only if you wanted! Or ..."

"I'd like that." Adora cut her off with a warm smile, and gestured with her head towards their apartments. "Walk with me?"

Maybe the brush of their hands on the quiet walk back was totally by accident, but how their fingers were linked together by the time they reached home certainly wasn't.


@Tarateacher3

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